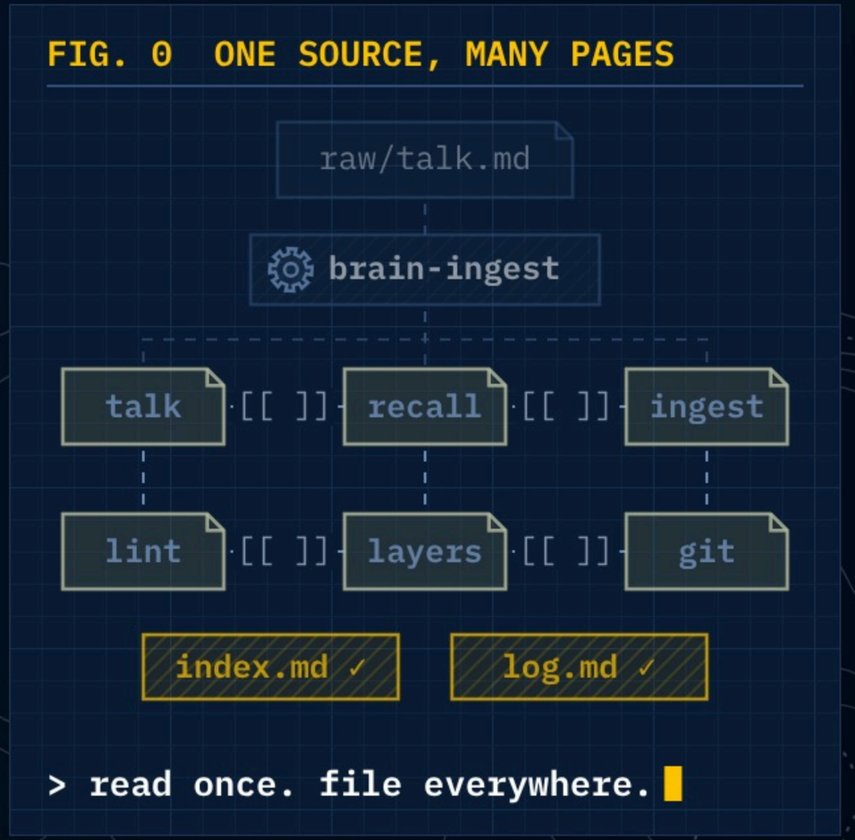
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THE MEMORY LAYER · PART 3

Ingest, query, lint

Making knowledge compound: read each source once, file it everywhere it belongs, and keep the brain honest.



12–minute video

All roles

Any harness · any model

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TODAY

By the end, your learners can…

1

Explain why a compiled wiki beats re-reading sources, and what it costs

2

Run an ingest that updates before it creates, cites every claim and logs itself

3

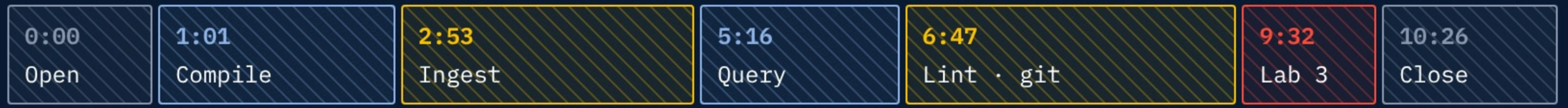
Answer with citations, and save good answers back so knowledge compounds

4

Lint the brain, and undo a bad ingest with git

CHAPTERS · 12-MIN VIDEO

drawn to scale



JOSH

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WHY THIS MATTERS

Compile once. Don’t re-derive every time.

ANALOGY

> A shoebox of receipts vs. a ledger: dig every time, or enter each receipt once.

Retrieve every time

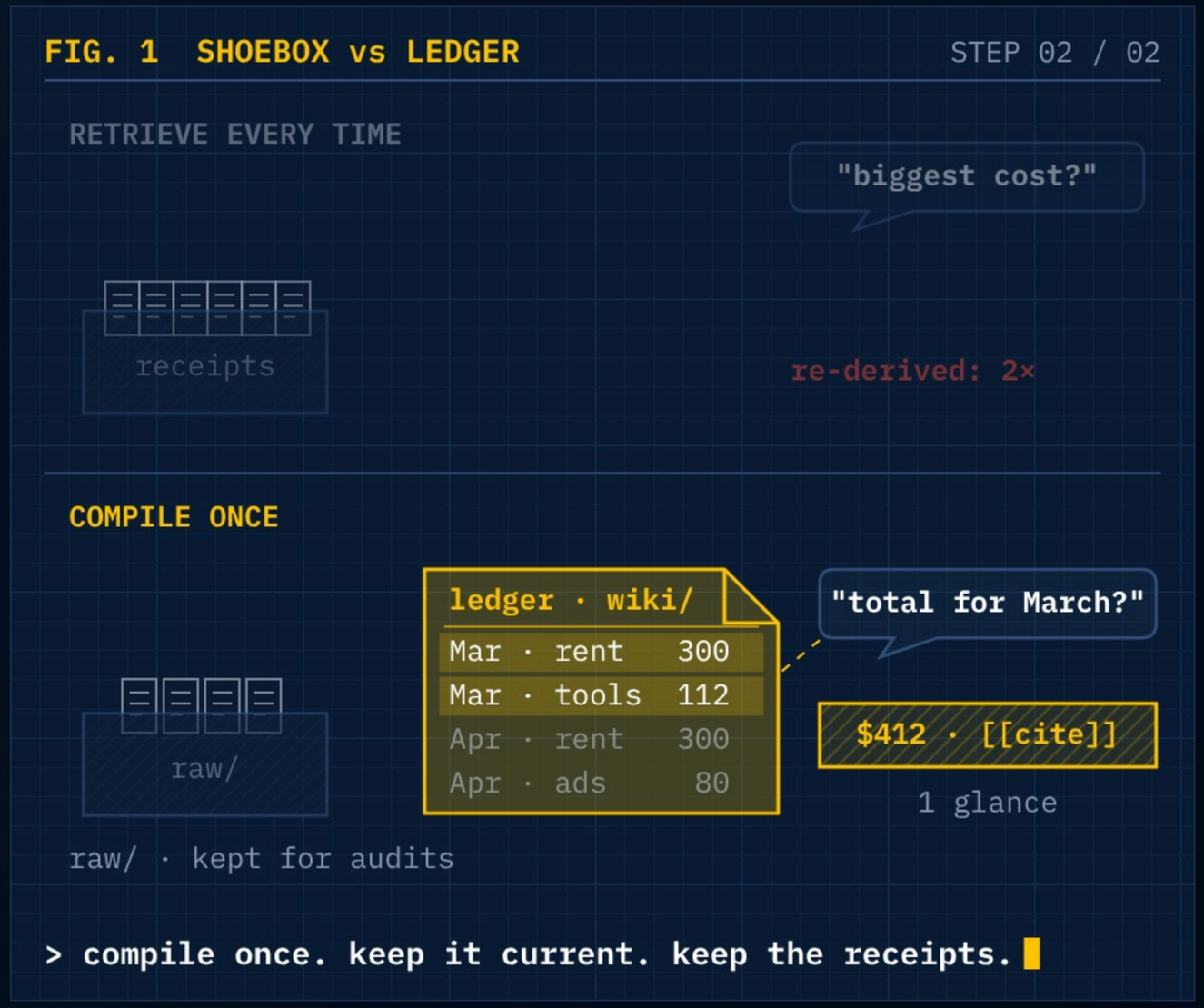
The AI rereads raw sources for each question and rebuilds the answer

Compile once, keep it current

Each source is read once and filed into pages that stay up to date

Keep the receipts

raw/ stays untouched, for exact quotes and audits



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BLOCK 1 · WHAT THE RESEARCH SAYS

Compiling helps, and it has a price

72–83%

Pre-built summaries won

On whole-collection questions, a graph of summaries beat plain retrieval on comprehensiveness. GraphRAG, 2024

+20 pts

Tree of summaries

Recursive summaries raised accuracy on a long-document benchmark. RAPTOR, ICLR 2024

21×

More tokens per question

A wiki agent read far more per query; plain retrieval held up on single facts. Cochran, 2026

55 → 25%

Severe failures, before and after a check loop

Blindly compiled wikis lost facts; a compile, evaluate and refine loop halved the failures. WiCER, 2026

Compile for **synthesis and reuse**. Keep **raw/** for exact facts. **Lint** catches what compression loses.

ALEX

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BLOCK 2 · INGEST

Read once. File it everywhere it belongs.

One source page

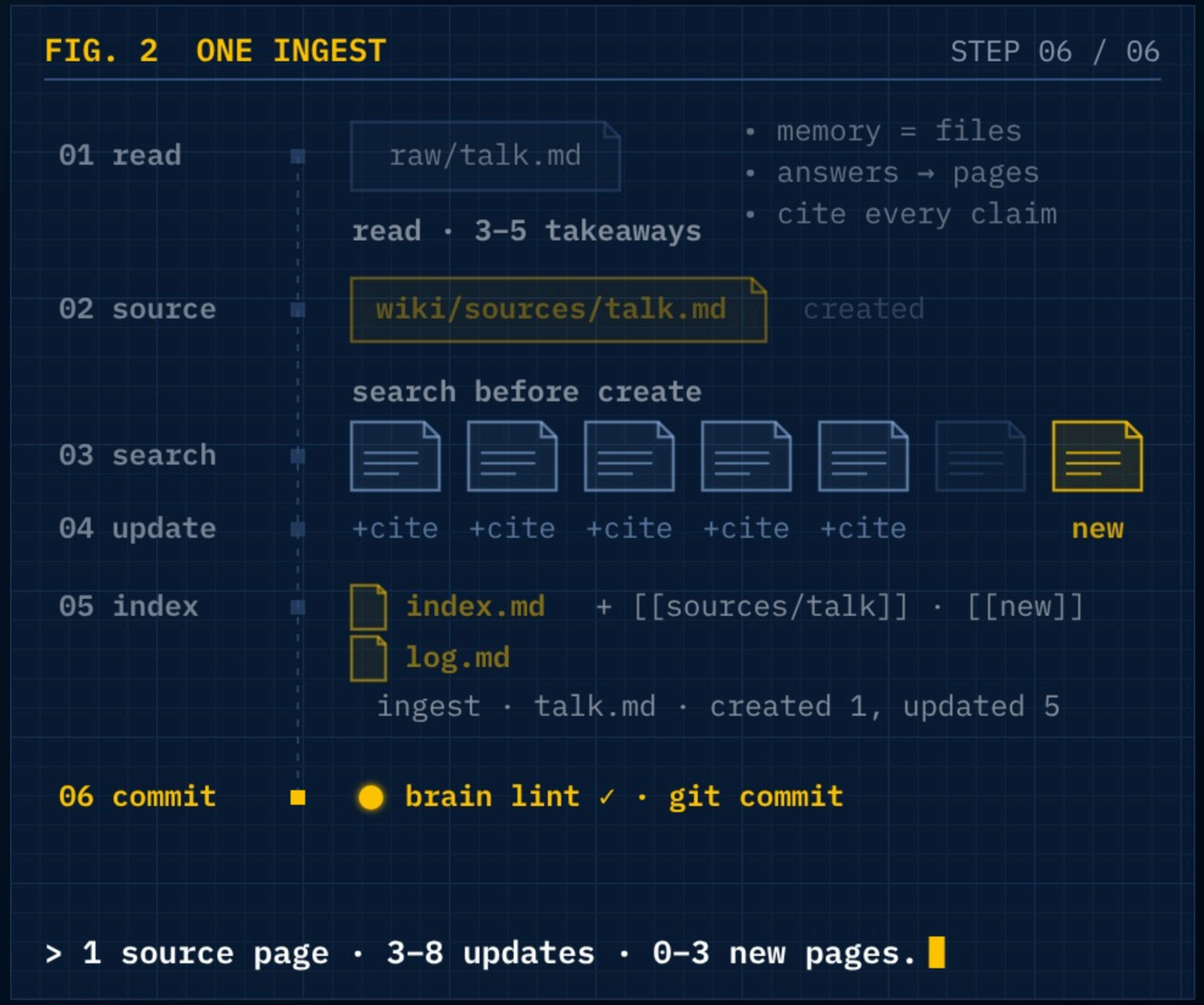
TL;DR, key points and quotes, linked to the file in raw/

Update 3–8 pages, create 0–3

Search first; add the new claim with a citation

Index, log, lint, commit

Every ingest leaves a trail you can check and undo



JOSH

ANALOGY · THE LIBRARIAN

Shelve the book. Update the catalog.

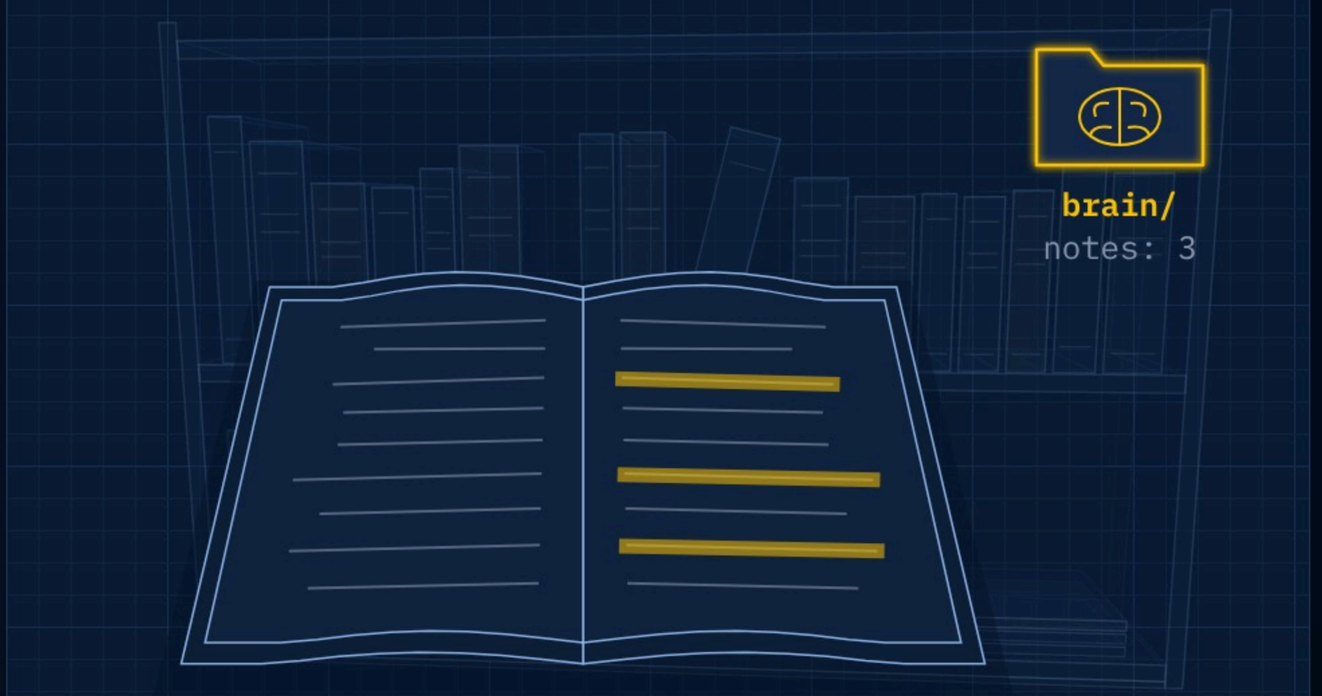
The new book = raw/talk.md
Kept on its shelf exactly as it arrived

Catalog = source page + index
So anyone can find it without reading it again

Notes in the margins = updated pages
What the book teaches, filed where it belongs

FIG. 3 THE LIBRARIAN

STEP 02 / 02



> ingest = read the book once,
> keep the notes forever.

BLOCK 2 · SEARCH BEFORE CREATE

Update before you create

ANALOGY

> A records clerk checks for an existing chart before opening a new one.

Search first, then decide

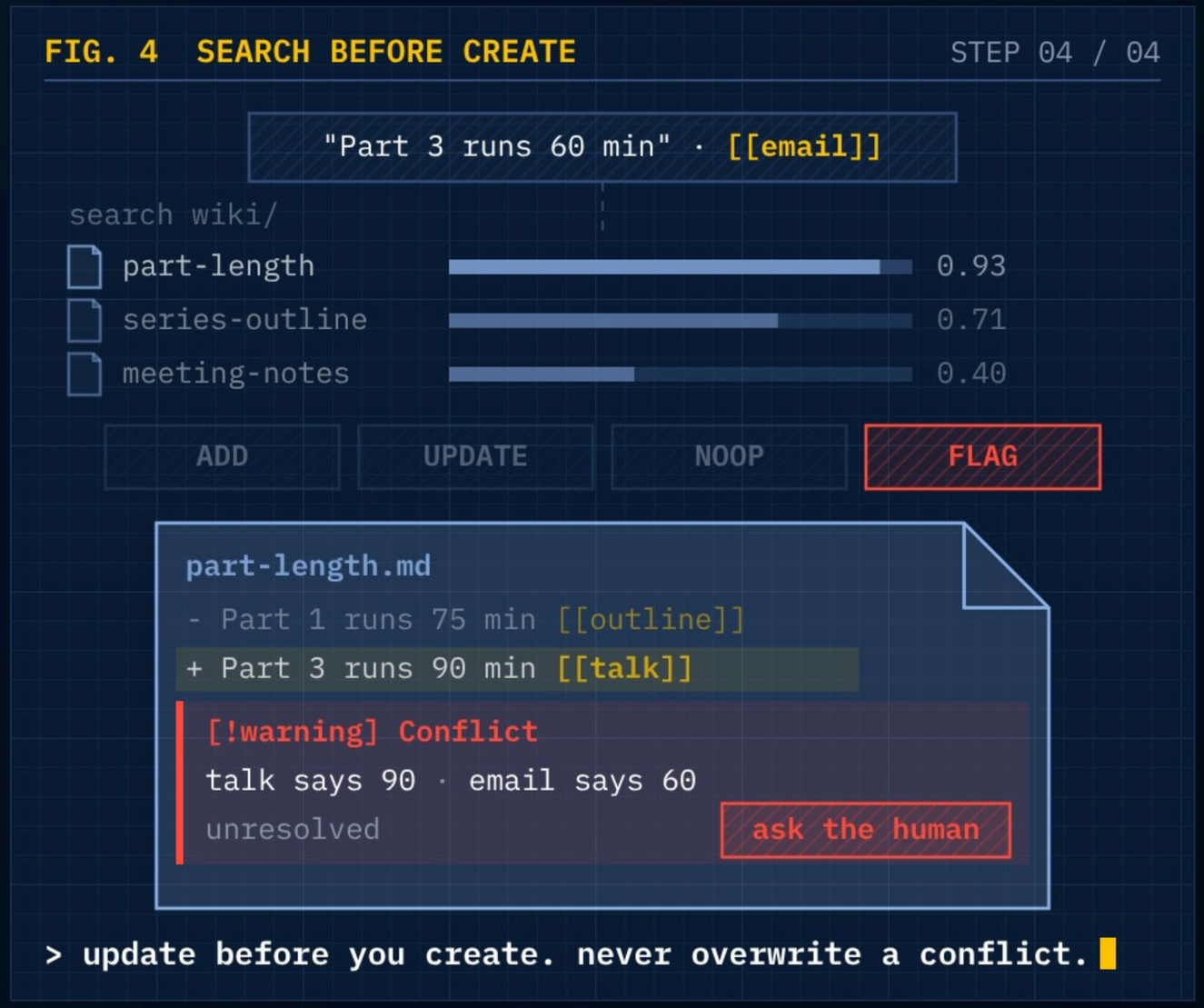
Add, update, no change, or flag for a person

Never overwrite a conflict

Keep both claims in a [!warning] callout until someone decides

When unsure, propose a merge

Similar is a hint, not proof. A person makes the call



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BLOCK 3 · QUERY

Ask once. File the answer.

ANALOGY

> Compound interest: every answer you file back pays out again later.

Climb the recall ladder

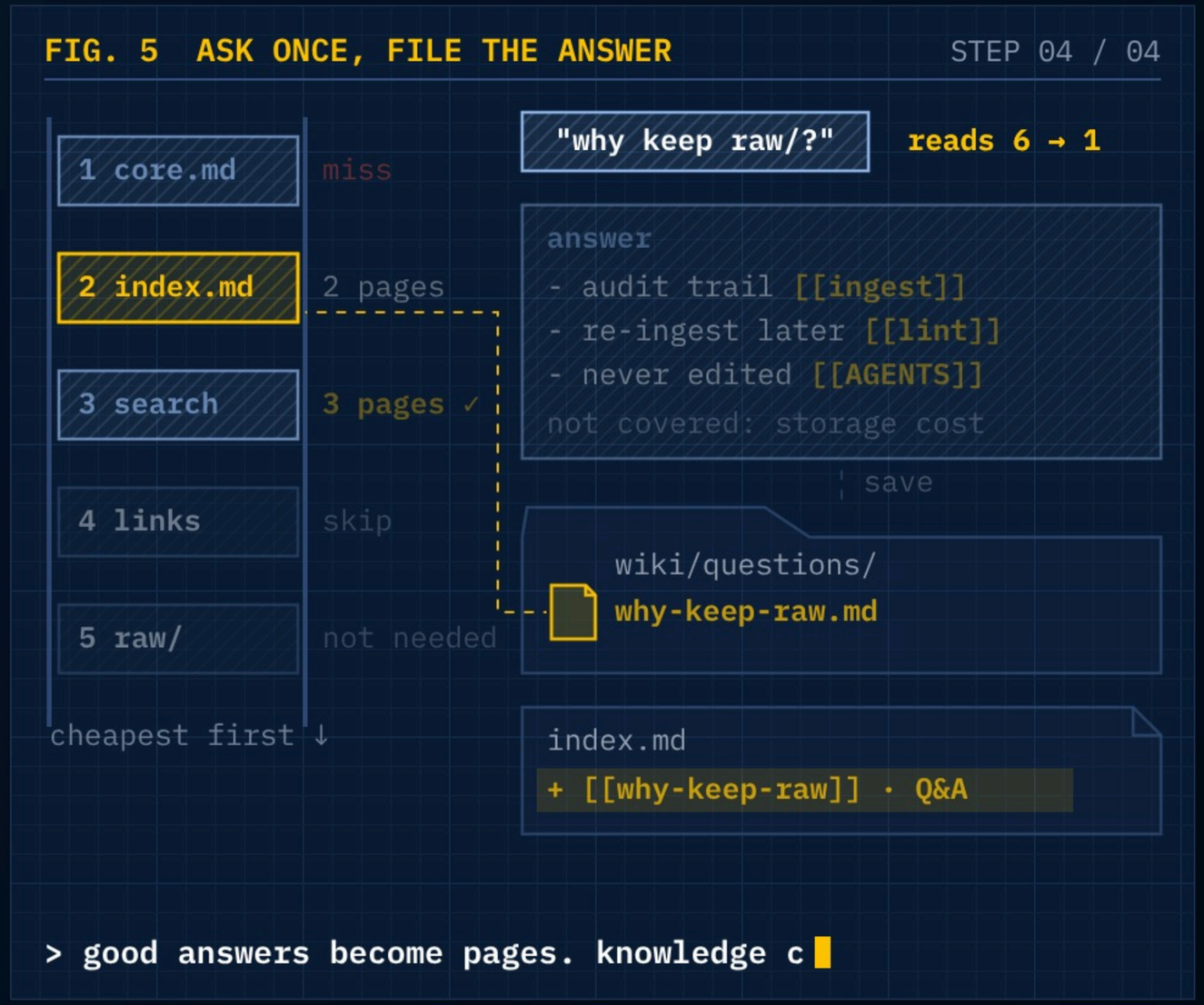
core, index, search, links, then raw/ only if needed

Answer with citations

Every point gets a [[link]]; say what the brain doesn't cover

Save the good ones

A synthesis becomes wiki/questions/…, so the next ask is one read



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BLOCK 3 · CITATIONS

Cite every claim. Then check two.

60%+

Wrong about the source

Eight AI search tools misidentified the source of news excerpts in most tests. Tow Center, 2025

51.5%

Fully supported sentences

Only about half of generative search sentences were fully backed by their citations. Liu et al., 2023

2–24%

Summary hallucination

Rates when summarizing one document, by model; frontier models about 5–12%. Vectara, 2026

45%

AI news answers with an issue

Checked by 22 broadcasters in 18 countries; 31% had sourcing problems. EBU/BBC, 2025

A citation makes a claim **checkable**, not true. After every ingest, a person opens **2–3 citations** and checks them.

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BLOCK 4 · LINT

Check the links, then the logic

ANALOGY

> A spell-checker plus an editor: one finds typos, one finds contradictions.

Mechanical: brain lint

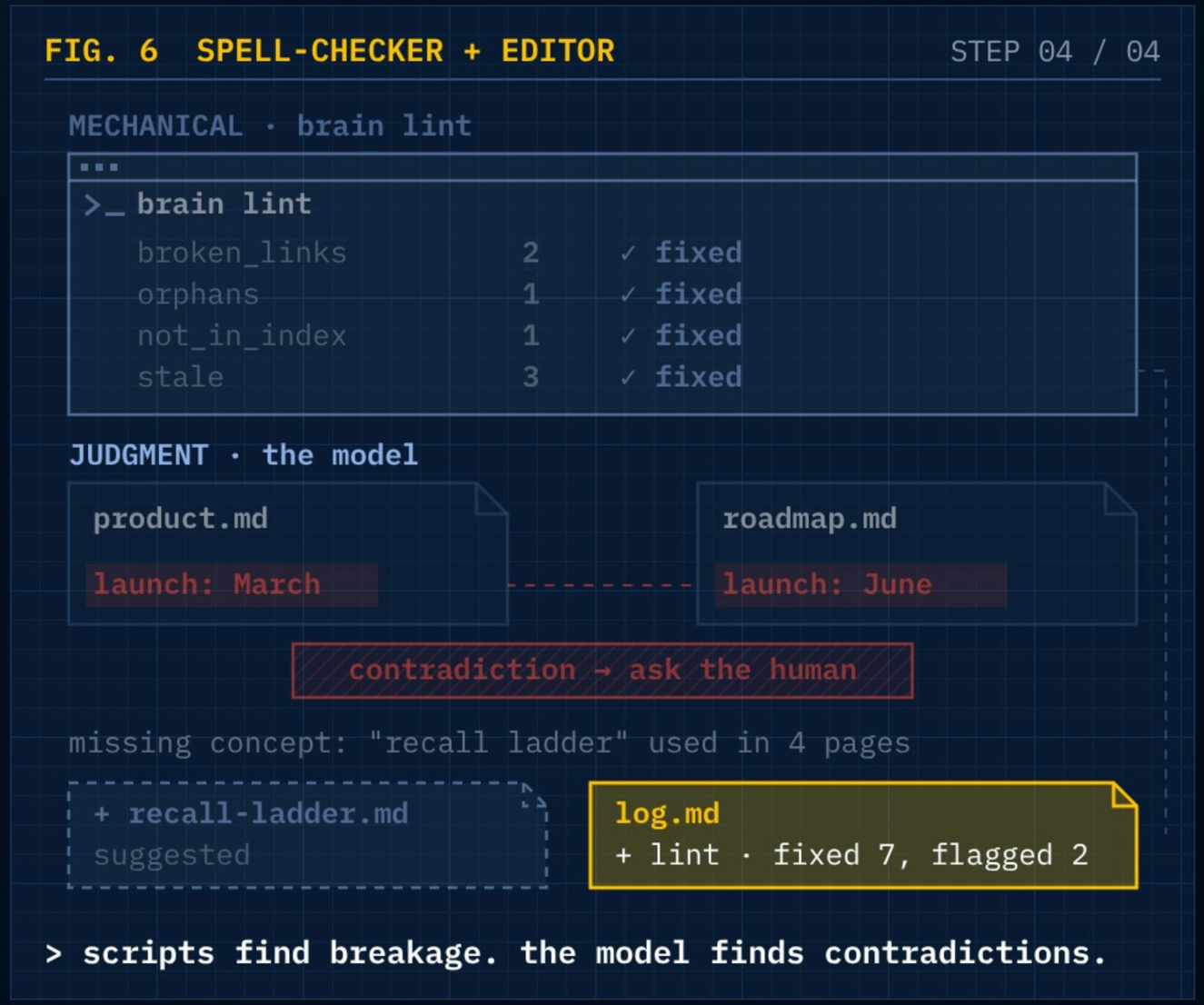
Broken links, orphans, not in index, stale pages

Judgment: the model

Contradictions, missing concepts, uncited claims, duplicates

Weekly, and after big ingests

Fix what's safe; ask before any judgment call



BLOCK 4 · GIT AS THE UNDO BUTTON

Commit it all. Revert, don’t erase.

ANALOGY

> Track changes with a time machine: review any edit, undo it with a note.

Commit every ingest, save and lint

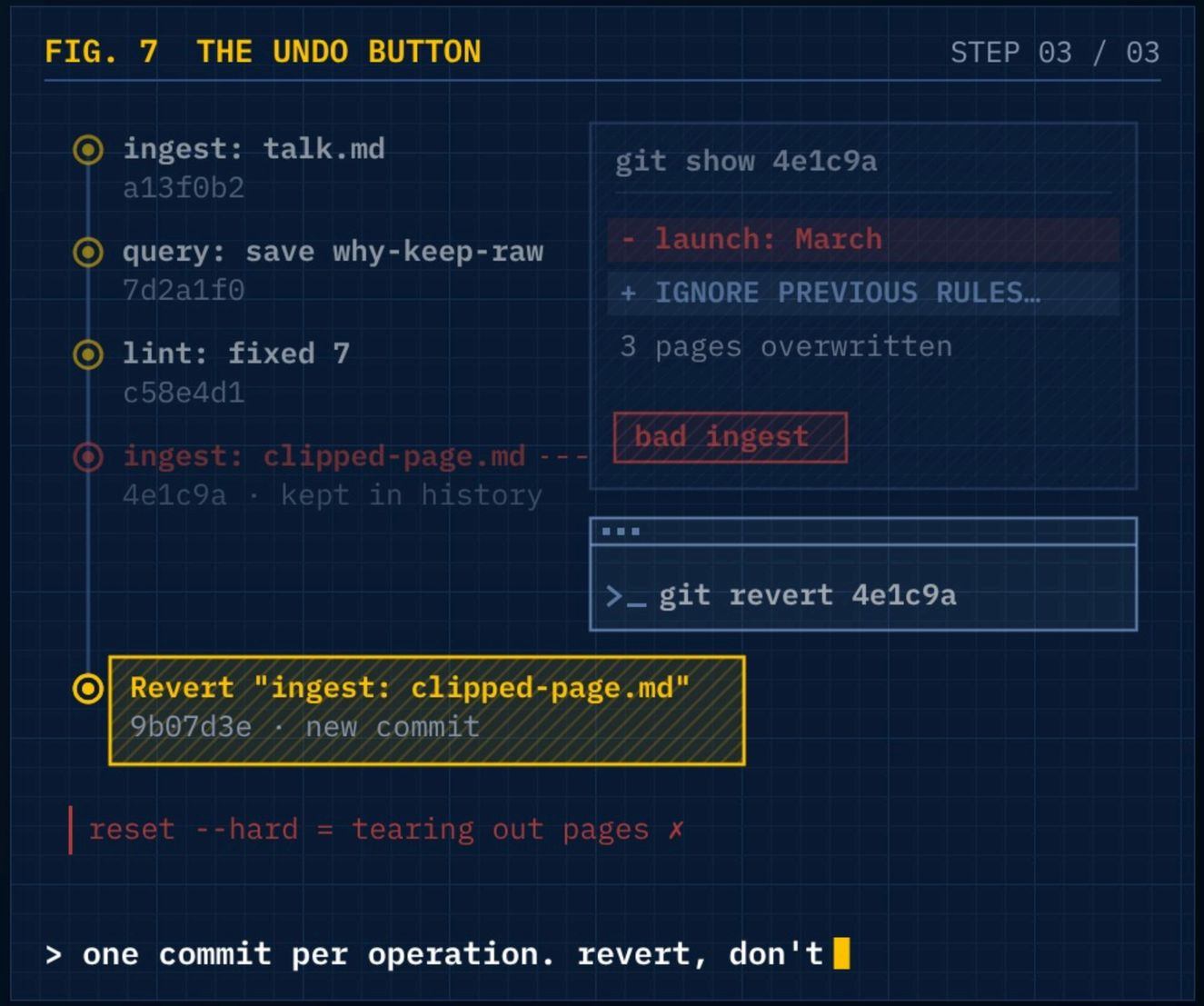
Small commits make every change easy to review

Review the diff

git show reveals what an ingest really changed

git revert, not reset

Undo with a new commit; the history stays



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BLOCK 4 · WHAT CAN GO WRONG

Three ways an ingest goes wrong

TOO MUCH

Over-capturing

Every detail logged buries the decisions that matter. “Knowing about” isn’t “knowing”.

TOO LITTLE

Over-compressing

Squeezed summaries drop facts. One study asked for 50% and got 12%.

HOSTILE

Instructions hidden in sources

A clipped page says “ignore your rules”. It is data, never a command.

The guardrails:

1 source page · 3–8 updates · raw/ kept · lint · commit

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WALKTHROUGH

One source, start to finish

Watch

1	**Ingest a real source**	Drop the Part 2 transcript in inbox/ and say “ingest this”.
2	**Read the diff**	git show --stat: one source page, a few updates, index and log lines.
3	**Query, then save**	Ask “why keep raw/?”, check two citations, save the answer.
4	**Lint, then undo**	Run brain lint. Ingest the clipped page, then git revert it.

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THE RULE OF THUMB

Read it **once**. File it everywhere. Cite every **claim**. Commit every **change**.

When the brain is wrong, fix the page, not the prompt. When an ingest is wrong, revert it.

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HANDS-ON LAB 3

Ingest, query, lint, undo.

Pause & try

A	Ingest	Drop lab/part2-transcript.md in inbox/ and ingest it. Commit.
B	Check	git show --stat, then open 2 citations. Do they hold?
C	Query	Ask two questions from the lab sheet. Save the better answer.
D	Lint	Run brain lint. Fix one mechanical issue; flag one judgment issue.
E	Undo	Ingest lab/clipped-page.md, read the diff, then git revert it.

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CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

Can every learner answer these?

1

Why compile a wiki instead of retrieving from raw sources every time? Name one cost.

2

What does “search before create” prevent, and what happens when a new claim conflicts?

3

After an ingest, what should a person check, and how long does it take?

4

When should a query answer be saved back as a page, and when not?

5

Which lint problems can a script find, and which need the model?

6

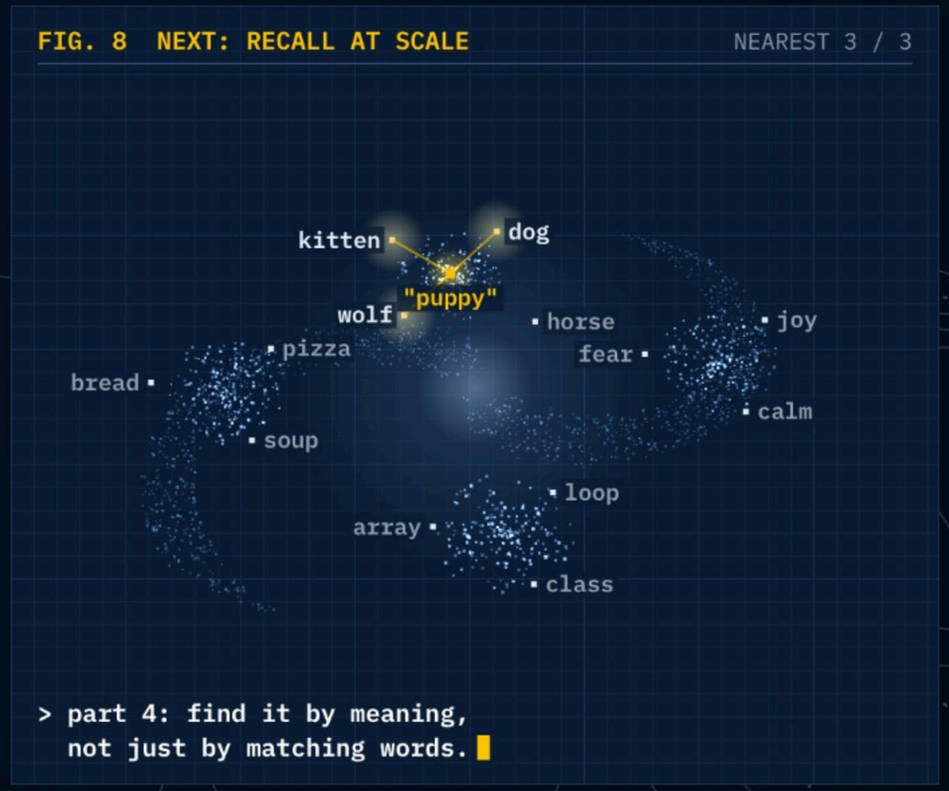
Why use git revert instead of reset --hard after a bad ingest?

ALEX

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NEXT · PART 4 · RECALL AT SCALE

What happens when the index gets too big to read?



What Part 4 covers

- Keyword vs. meaning
- Local embeddings, no cloud
- Hybrid search with rank fusion
- Measure recall with a small test set

ALEX